MIL-F-40045C
30 September 1970
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-40045B
30 December 1964

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FLAG SET, SIGNAL, M-238 (TANK)

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers one type of flag set used by tanks. The set consists of three flags with flagstaffs and flag case.

1.2 Classification.- The M-238 flag set consists of the following components:

Flag set, Signal M-238 (Tank)

Component A - Case CS-90
Component B - Flagstaff MC-270 (3 each)
Component C - Flag MC-273 (red)
Component D - Flag MC-274 (yellow)
Component E - Flag MC-275 (green)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-285 - Thread, Polyester
TT-V-119 - Varnish, Spar, Phenolic-resin
CCC-C-419 - Cloth, Cotton, Duck, Unbleached, Plied Yarns (Army and Numbered)
CCC-C-439 - Cloth, Cotton, Bunting, Mercerized
CCC-D-950 - Dyeing and Aftertreating Processes for Cotton Fabrics

/FSC 8345/

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DDD-L-20 - Labels, Printed and Markings, General Use (For Clothing, Equipage and Tentage)
DDD-T-86 - Tape, Cotton, Bleached, Dyed or Gray, General Use
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-W-530 - Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors
MIL-R-3390 - Rings, d
MIL-W-6110 - Wood, Determination of Moisture Content of
MIL-F-10884 - Fasteners, Snap
MIL-S-13518 - Sealer, Surface, Wood Preservative
MIL-T-43566 - Tape, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

Fed Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

5-1-304 - Flag, Signal, Tank (Set)
5-1-322 - Case and Flagstaff for Flag Set M-238, Assembly and Details

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawings required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

(Figures 1 and 2 are miniature copies of the referenced drawings and are attached for information only.)

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2.2 Other publications.- The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES, INC.

U.S. Army Color Card, The Official Colors for Branches, Agencies, Etc. Standard Color Card of America, 9th Edition

(Application for copies of the above color cards should be addressed to the Color Association of the United States, Inc., 200 Madison Ave., NY, NY 10016.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard shade sample.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contracting officer will furnish the manufacturer a standard shade sample of the olive drab cotton duck used for the case and a standard shade sample of the red, yellow and green cotton bunting used for the flags. The shade samples shall be used for matching color and colorfastness only.

3.2 First article.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced a first article of a completely fabricated flag set or component as applicable, shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for test as specified in 4.2. The approval of the first article authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor from compliance with all provisions of this specification. The first article shall be manufactured by the contractor in the same facilities and in the same manner and form as will be used for the manufacture of the production item.

3.3 Materials.- Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and to the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Cloth, cotton, bunting, mercerized.- Cloth for the flags shall be mercerized cotton bunting conforming to CCC-C-439.

3.3.1.1 Color.- The bunting for the MC-273 flag (red) shall be dyed red to match Cable No. 65020). The bunting for the MC-274 flag (yellow) shall be dyed yellow to match Cable No. 65002. The bunting for MC-275 flag (green) shall be dyed green to match Cable No. 70168.

3.3.2 Tie tape for flags.- The tie tapes of the flags shall be 1/2 inch wide conforming to type II, class 3 of DDD-T-86 and shall be dyed to match the colors of the flags to which they are to be sewn.

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3.3.3 Cloth, cotton duck.- The cloth for the flag case shall be cotton duck conforming to type I, No. 10, hard texture of CCC-C-419, and shall be dyed olive drab Shade No. 7 to match the standard shade sample furnished (see 3.1).

3.3.3.1 Treatment.- The cotton duck shall be treated in accordance with class B of CCC-D-950.

3.3.4 Tape for edge binding.- The tape for binding the edges of the case shall be 3/4 inch in width and shall conform to type I, class 4 of MIL-T-43566. The tape shall be dyed olive drab Shade No. 7 and shall match the standard shade sample (see 3.1).

3.3.5 Webbing.- The webbing for D ring chape and for the tie tapes of the flag case shall be 3/4 inch in width and shall conform to type IIA, class 4 of MIL-W-530. The webbing shall be dyed olive drab Shade No. 7.

3.3.6 Thread, polyester.- Thread shall conform to V-T-285. The types, classes and sizes shall be as follows:

For flag stitching - Type I or II, class 1, size B, subclass A for needle and bobbin
For case stitching - Type I or II, class 1, size FF, subclass A for needle and bobbin

3.3.6.1 Color.- Thread used for flag stitching shall be dyed to match the color of the flag on which the thread is to be used. Thread for the case stitching shall be dyed to match olive drab Shade S-1.

3.3.7 Wood.- Wood for the flagstaffs shall be selected straight grained wood of a species listed below. The wood shall be free from all defects other than medium surface checks, small knots and medium strain. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the maximum moisture content of the wood shall be 8 percent.

Ash	Birch
Maple	Beech
Hickory	Walnut

3.3.8 Fastener, snap.- The snap fasteners for the case shall conform to style 2, finish 2 of MIL-F-10084.

3.3.9 D ring.- The D ring for the flag case shall conform to class 1, style 1, symbol C of MIL-R-3390, except the diameter of the wire to fabricate the ring may be .152 inch (nominal).

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3.3.10 Sealer (wood preservative).- Sealer for the flagstaff shall conform to type I or II of MIL-S-13518.

3.3.11 Varnish.- Varnish for the flagstaff shall be clear, gloss varnish conforming to TT-V-119.

3.4 Components.- The flag set shall be composed of three signal flags, one red (MC-273), one yellow (MC-274) and one green (MC-275); three flagstaffs (MC-270) and one case (CS-90).

3.5 Construction.- Components of the signal flag set shall be constructed in accordance with the applicable drawings and the requirements specified herein.

3.5.1 Stitching.- Stitching shall be in accordance with Std. No. 751. All stitching for the flags shall be type 301 with 10 to 12 stitches to the inch. All stitching for the case shall be type 301 with 6 to 8 stitches to the inch. Thread breaks in stitching shall be backstitched not less than one inch at each break. Stitching shall be backstitched not less than one inch at the ends, except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching and that the lock will be embedded in the center of the material sewn. There shall be no loose or untrimmed threads on the finished flags or flag case.

3.6 Details of components.-

3.6.1 Component A (flag case).- The flag case shall be fabricated from cotton duck specified in 3.3.3, and shall be in accordance with the details and dimensions of drawing 5-1-322. The edges of the case shall be bound with tape specified in 3.3.4. The ends of the tape shall be overlapped 1-1/2 inches, plus or minus 1/4 inch and the overlap shall be backstitched one inch, plus or minus 1/4 inch. The case shall have a tie tape fabricated from webbing specified in 3.3.5. The end of the tie tape shall be bias cut to an angle of 45 degrees. The case shall have a snap fastener specified in 3.3.8, located as shown. If a hole is punched before inserting the male or female part of the fastener, it shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the fastener tube so that the tube must be forced through the hole. The fasteners must be securely clinched without cutting the material. The male fastener on the body of the case shall be positioned on center 1-1/2 inches plus or minus 1/4 inch, from bound edge of opening. The female fastener on the cover of the case shall be positioned one inch, plus or minus 1/4 inch, from bound edge of cover. The case shall contain three pockets sufficiently large to allow the insertion of one flag rolled on its staff in each pocket. When the flag case is procured separately, three dowels 1-1/2 inches in diameter and 36 inches in length, may be used in lieu of flag to test pocket size (see 4.3.2.1.2 1/).

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3.6.2 Component B (flagstaff).- The flagstaff shall be fabricated from wood specified in 3.3.7, and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawing 5-1-322. The flagstaff shall be sanded to a smooth surface and shall be given one coat of sealer specified in 3.3.10 and one coat of varnish specified in 3.3.11.

3.6.3 Components C, D and E (flag MC-273, MC-274 and MC-275).- The flags shall be fabricated from mercerized cotton bunting specified in 3.3.1, and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawing 5-1-304.

3.7 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), marking shall be as specified in 3.7.1 and 3.7.2.

3.7.1 Components A, C, D and E (flags and flag case).- The flags and flag case shall be marked as indicated on the applicable drawing. The identification markings shall conform to the markings of type IV, class 9 labels in DDD-L-20. The fastness of the markings shall be as specified for type IV, class 5 labels of DDD-L-20.

3.7.2 Component B (flagstaff).- The flagstaff shall be marked as shown on drawing 5-1-322.

3.8 Assembly.- When the set is procured as a unit, the set shall be assembled as follows: The flagstaffs shall be inserted into the tunnel of the flag heading as far as possible. One end of the tie tape of the flag shall then be passed through the drilled hole on the flagstaff while the other end is passed around the flagstaff. The ends of the tape shall then be tied together using a bow knot. After the assembly of the flags and flagstaffs has been completed, the flags shall be wound around their staffs and inserted in the applicable pockets of the flag case. The case shall then be closed by use of the snap fastener.

3.9 Workmanship.- The flag set and the components of the flag set covered by this specification shall be clean, well made and shall meet the acceptable quality levels established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to

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perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection.- When a first article is required, inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on a completely finished flag set or component as applicble, for all provisions of this specification applicable to end item examination and tests.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance.- Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1 Inspection of materials.-

4.3.1.1 Testing of materials.- In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on the material listed in table I. The inspection level shall be performed on the mateial listed in table I. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I Testing of materials.-

Component or material and lots expressed in terms of	Characteristics	Rqm't para	Test method	Rqm't applicable to individual	#determs per sample	Results reported as	Sample unit
Wood (100 board feet)	Moisture content	3.3.7	4.4.1	x	3	Average nearest 0.1%	1 board at time of fabrication
	Species	3.3.7	Visual	x	1	Pass or fail	

4.3.1.2 Certification of compliance.- The wood in the flagstaff may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for the requirements listed below. However the Government reserves the right to check test the material.

Material	Requirement	Rqm't para.
Wood	Moisture content	3.3.7
	Species	3.3.7

4.3.2 Inspection of end item.-

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4.3.2.1 Examination of end item.- The defects found during examinations shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.2.1.1 and 4.3.2.1.2. The unit of product for these examinations shall be one flag set or component as applicable. However should a flag set be required the flagstaff shall be examined prior to assembly with the flag.

4.3.2.1.1 Examination for visual defects.- Examination for visual defects shall be made from a distance of 16 to 18 inches under illumination equal to natural (North Sky) daylight. Defects so designated by an asterisk shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance and serviceability and minor when affecting appearance and serviceability but not seriously.

Examine	Defects	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
Flagstaff				
Finish	Not finished as specified.....	x	-	-
	Finish not adherent, i.e., peeling, blistering, flaking or area of no film or thin film.....	-	*	-
	Foreign matter imbedded or evidence of grease or dirt under varnish.....	-	*	-
	Scratch or gouge exposing base wood.....	-	*	-
	Heavy stain.....	-	-	x
Drilled hole	Missing or incorrect size.....	x	-	-
	Not centered.....	-	*	-
	Crooked or not cleanly drilled.....	-	*	-
Material	Other than species of wood specified.....	x	-	-
Design	Any characteristic not in accordance with the specified requirements.....	x	-	-
Construction and workmanship	Any large check, split, crack, torn or raised grain or other defect affecting serviceability...	-	*	-
	Any rot, decay, pith, shake or wane.....	-	*	-
	Any unsound knot, knothole or any burl with an unsound center.....	x	-	-
	Any sound tight knot exceeding 1/2 inch in the largest dimension.....	-	-	x
	Not straight, i.e., any warp, bow, cup or twist exceeding 1/32 of an inch per foot of length.....	-	*	-
	Marking is missing, illegible, misspelled, incorrect, not specified size or color.....	x	-	-
Flag				
Fabric	Holes or any weakening defects, such as, smashes, multiple floats or loose and weakening slubs.....	-	*	-
	Color not as specified.....	x	-	-

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Examine	Defects	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
	Any needle chews	-	*	-
	Any scissors or knife cut, tear, mend or burn	x	-	-
	Shade bars or off shade, affecting appearance	-	*	-
Tape	Missing	x	-	-
	Not securely stitched at bottom of flag	x	-	-
	Does not match the color of the flag on which it is used	-	*	-
Cleanness	Spots or stains of an obvious permanent nature	x	-	-
	Removable spots or stains clearly noticeable	-	*	-
Heading	Not closed at top edge	x	-	-
	Bottom not open	x	-	-
Marking	Marking missing, incorrect or illegible	x	-	-
Seams and stitching	Gauge of stitching irregular, i.e., unevenly gauged	-	*	-
	Various stitchings not uniform affecting appearance	-	-	x
	Open seams on hem 1/2 inch or more	-	-	x
	Open seams on hem less than 1/2 inch at two or more places	x	-	-
	NOTE: One or more broken or two or more continuous skipped or run-off stitches constitutes an open seam. Double stitched seams are considered open when the opening occurs on either one or both sides of the seam.			
	Ends of stitching not backstitched at least one inch (when not caught in other seams or stitching)	x	-	-
	Any raw edge	-	*	-
	Hems not tucked under and sewn with two rows of stitching 3/32 inch apart	x	-	-
	Wrong stitch type	-	*	-
	Thread breaks backstitched less than one inch	-	*	-
	NOTE: Thread breaks not backstitched shall be classified as open seams.			
	Loose tension resulting in loosely exposed bobbin or top thread	x	-	-
	Tight tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to the stitching)	x	-	-
	NOTE: Puckering is evidence of tight tension. When puckering is evident, the inspector shall test stitch by exerting normal pull in the lengthwise direction of the stitching.			
	Two or three stitches per inch less than specified	-	-	x

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Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
	Four or more stitches more than required	x	-	-
	Any row of required stitching missing.....	x	-	-
Flag case				
Fabric	Not as specified.....	x	-	-
	Not finish specified.....	x	-	-
	Any hole, cut or tear.....	-	*	-
	Fabric defects.....	-	*	-
Hardware	Broken or malformed, protective finish omitted, corroded areas, burrs or sharp edges which may cause injury when handling.....	x	-	-
Seams and stitching				
Open seams	Open seams more than 1/4 inch but not more than 1 inch.....	-	-	x
	Open seam more than 1 inch.....	x	-	-
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more skipped stitches or run-offs occur. On double stitched seams a seam shall be considered open when either one or both sides of a seam are open.			
Raw edges	Any raw edge, except on exposed end of binding and on ends of tie tape.....	-	-	x
	NOTE: Raw edges not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as open seams.			
Seam and stitch type (Run-off, see open seams)				
Stitch tension	Loose stitch tension, resulting in loosely exposed bobbin or top thread.....	-	-	x
	Tight stitch tension resulting in puckering of fabric on seams.....	-	*	-
Stitches per inch	One or two stitches per inch less than minimum specified.....	-	-	x
	Three or more stitches per inch less than minimum specified.....	x	-	-
	One to three stitches in excess of maximum specified.....	-	-	x
	Four or more stitches in excess of maximum.....	-	*	-
Stitching margins; stitching gauge				
Thread breaks	Thread breaks backstitched less than one inch.....	x	-	-
	NOTE: Thread breaks not backstitched shall be classified as an open seam.	x	-	-

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Examine	Defects	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
Stitching ends	Stitching ends backstitched less than one inch, except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching	-	-	x
Cross box-stitching	Cross box-stitching incomplete	-	-	x
	One end row of stitching omitted	-	-	x
	Two end rows of stitching omitted	x	-	-
	Any other row (except end row) of stitching omitted	x	-	-
Component and assembly	Any required component or part of case missing (unless otherwise classified herein)	x	-	-
	Needle chews which may develop into holes	x	-	-
	Mends or darns	-	*	-
	Any required row of stitching omitted	x	-	-
Details of construction				
Binding	Loosely or improperly applied	-	*	-
Flag and bottom	Edge of flap or bottom corners irregularly shaped or radius not uniform	-	*	-
Back	D ring chape or tie tape not attached to back of case	x	-	-
Snap fasteners	Not functioning properly, failing to effect a secure closure or to open freely	x	-	-
	Set off center of flap or center pocket:			
	-by 1/4 inch but less than 1/2 inch	-	-	x
	-by 1/2 inch or more	-	*	-
Marking	Omitted, illegible, incorrect, misplaced or size characters not as specified	x	-	-
Cleanness	Grease or oil stains clearly noticeable; thread ends not trimmed throughout	-	*	-
Assembly	Any component missing	x	-	-
	Flag not properly secured to flagstaff	x	-	-
	Tape knot other than bow	-	-	x
	Flag does not fit properly in appropriate pocket.	x	-	-
	Flag in wrong pocket	-	-	x
	Flap fails to provide a smooth and secure closure.	-	*	-

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4.3.2.1.2 Examination for defects in dimensions.- Defects in dimensions shall be as classified below. The unit of examination shall be one flag set or component as applicable.

Not within the specified tolerance.	
One or more pockets too small, i.e., dowels fail to fit into any pocket of case. 1/	
Flap too short, causing failure of snap fastener to effect a smooth and secure closure. 1/	

1/ Fit examination shall be performed with three 1-1/2 inch diameter dowels, 36 inches long. The dowels shall be inserted into the case pockets. To determine whether dowels fit in case, ease dowels in case pockets without effort and close flap by snapping fastener into a closed position.

4.3.2.1.3 Inspection level and AQL'S.- The inspection levels and the AQL's expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For defects applicable to 4.3.2.1.1	II	2.5	10.0
For defects applicable to 4.3.2.1.2	S-3	one class	4.0

4.3.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the except that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible or improper size, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing.
	Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.
	Bulging or distortion of containers.

4.4 Test.-

4.4.1 Test for moisture content of wood.- Moisture content of the wood shall be determined in accordance with MIL-W-6110. Results shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.3.7.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.-

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging.-

5.1.1.1.1 Flag set.- Each complete flag set shall be placed in a snug-fitting, transparent polyethylene bag. All seams and closures shall be affected by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat sealing operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled. The bag shall have a film thickness of not less than 0.0015 inch thick.

5.1.1.1.2 Flag set components.- When individual components of flag sets are procured separately, the components shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.2.

5.1.2 Level C.- Each flag set or component of the flag set shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from source of supply to the first receiving station. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.- Flag sets or components of flag sets packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to overseas type, style A, B, I or J of PPP-B-601 or class 2 of PPP-B-621. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable container specification.

5.2.2 Level B.- Flag sets or components of flag sets packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to type CF or SF, class weather-resistant of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C.- Flag sets and when applicable components of the flag sets, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules and regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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5.3.1 Polyethylene bagged packages.- Polyethylene bagged packages shall have the required information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification. The bag or label shall indicate the following information:

STOCK NUMBER
NOMENCLATURE
QUANTITY
MANUFACTURER'S NAME

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The flag set covered by this specification is intended to be used by tank personnel. The individual flags within the set will be used as signal flags.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When only one component is required (see 1.2).
(c) When a standard shade sample will not be furnished (see 3.1).
(d) When a first article sample will not be required (see 3.2).
(e) When special marking is required (see 3.7).
(f) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Standard shade sample.- For standard shade samples of cotton duck, webbing, tape or cotton bunting (red, green and/or yellow as applicable) address the office issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

6.4 Contract data requirements.- Data conforming to Department of Defense Data Item Descriptions DI-R-4803, DI-R-4805, DI-T-4901, DI-T-4902, DI-T-4903 and DI-T-4904 will usually be required for delivery in connection with this specification for Marine Corps procurements.

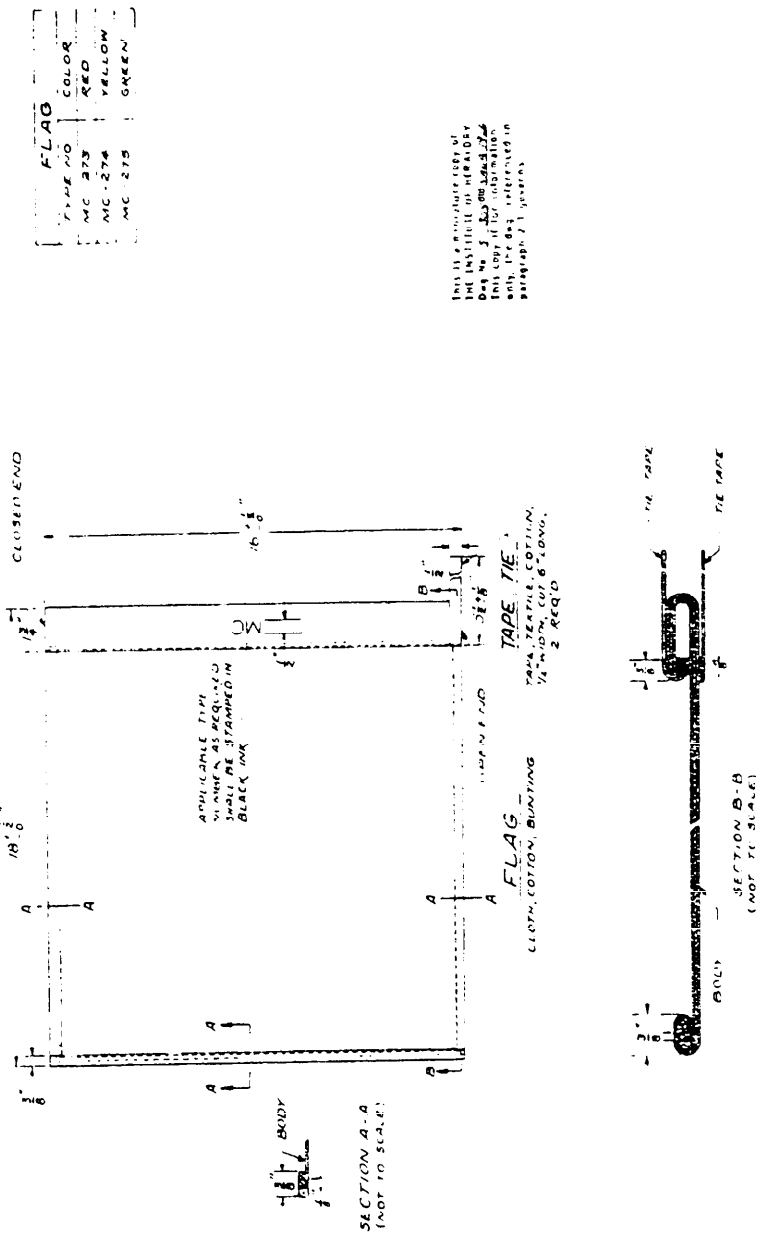
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Army - IH
Review Activity:
Other - DP
User Activities:
Army - SM
Navy - MC

Preparing Activity:

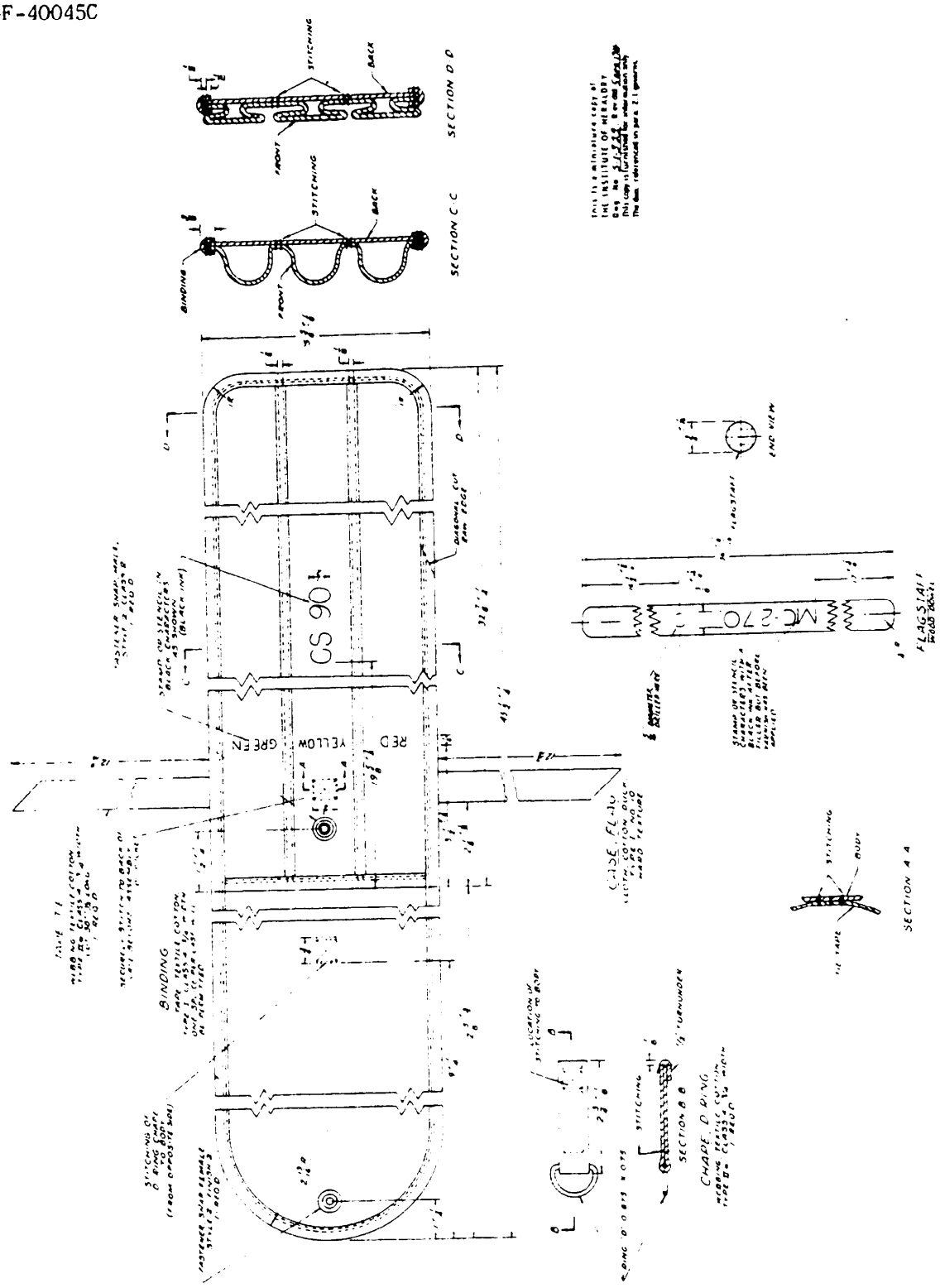
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